

Figure I.4 *Shahr-i Zuhhak (fifth–thirteenth centuries), general view, view along crenellated fortifications, with valley in background. © Photograph Josephine Powell* c. *1960. Harvard Fine Arts Library, Special Collections.*

Gandhara, the Panjab, and the Ganga-Yamuna *duab* under their aegis. Thereafter, the Yamini-Ghaznavids (*c.* AH 365–582/975–1186 CE) conducted plundering raids into the *duab* but with minimal traces of an imperial presence there.[7] The Kushanas' imperial expansion had had important consequences for all of Eurasia throughout the first millennium CE.[8] Nearly a thousand years later, the Shansabanis created a similar confederate empire (see esp. Chapters 1, 3–5, this volume), extending from the western Hari Rud through the Kuh-i Baba range in modern Afghanistan, to the Sulaiman Mountains and the Indus valleys of modern Pakistan, and ultimately reaching the northern plains of modern India. In the footsteps of the Kushanas (rather than the Ghaznavids), then, the Shansabanis *re*-conjoined the Indic and Iranian cultural–geographical worlds and unleashed far-reaching consequences, this time throughout the second millennium CE into the present day.

As further examined in these volumes, two among these consequences